

Medford School Committee Meeting

April 12, 2021

Remote Meeting by ZOOM

Executive Session: 5:00 PM

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

ZOOM Meeting ID: 996 1930 3508

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Read Intro: 5:01PM

I. Roll Call and Salute the Flag

Kathy Kreatz, Jenny Graham, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Breanna Lungo-Koehn; 6 present, 1 absent (Melanie McLaughlin)

II. Negotiations and Legal Matters - Executive Session

Return to regular session: 7:15pm

III. Approval of Minutes:

1. March 22, 2021 School Committee Meeting Melanie/Paul Ruseau

Roll: Jenny Graham, kathy, Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 yay/0 nay minutes approved

IV. Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls MM/Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative: bills and payrolls approved

V. Report of Secretary - nothing

VI. Report of Committees

1. Curriculum Subcommittee Meeting, March 10, 2021 - Paulette Van der Kloot, Chair, Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative: minutes approved

2. Committee of the Whole Meeting (Columbus Renaming), March 10, 2021 - Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, Minutes Approved with one edit from Paul Ruseau Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative
3. Committee of the Whole Meeting (CIP), March 22, 2021 - Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative: minutes approved
4. Rules, Policy & Equity Subcommittee Meeting, March 24, 2021 - Paul Ruseau;
 - Proposed Policy on Face Coverings - motion to table policy until April 26 meeting: mm/Kathy Kreatz roll Jenny Graham - no, Paul Ruseau - no; all rest yes: tabled until April 26.

Paul Ruseau: MPS has no policy on face coverings right now.

Dave Murphy: Supt. has issued a directive that all students and personnel wear masks. It is not voluntary right now. The committee can adopt a policy but in the absence of a policy, Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent has the ability to issue a directive on this.

Motion to approve the minutes: Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative: minutes approved

5. Committee of the Whole Meeting - Strategic Plan Roundtable, Session One, April 5, 2021 - Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn

Motion to approve minutes: Kathy Kreatz/Jenny Graham

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative: minutes approved

6. Committee of the Whole Meeting - Strategic Plan Roundtable, Session Two, April 6, 2021 - Paulette Van der Kloot

Melanie: We need to better address the needs of the EL

Motion to approve minutes: Kathy Kreatz/Jenny Graham

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative: minutes approved

7. Rules, Policy & Equity Subcommittee Meeting, April 7, 2021 - Paul Ruseau Proposed changes to School Committee meeting agendas

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau

Roll: 7/0

Motion to consent agenda; motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Jenny Graham

Roll: 7/0

Motion to move the Report of the secretary to before Public Participation:

Paulette Van der Kloot: in truth, I was confused. It is the vice chair who reads the emails. We need to ask the secretary if there should be a report every meeting.

Melanie McLaughlin: I think that there should be a conversation at the RPE about school committee orientation for new members.

Kathy Kreatz: When I was the secretary, there was no direction as to what to report. I would take a few select bills to highlight. I am ok with it being removed from the agenda.

Paul Ruseau: I would motion to table this item. I think we should ask whether we need to have it at all.

Melanie McLaughlin: second

Roll: 7/0

- Policy on Staff Conduct;
Policy approved: 7/0
- Policy on Harassment: attorney sent us policies that we need to update. Motion to approve it as written.
Melanie McLaughlin: Can someone read the motion?
Policy approved 7/0

VII. Community Participation

Two emails: One After School/Before School Program

VIII. Acceptance of the Proposed Extension of the Superintendent's Contract by the Medford School Committee.

Motion to approve: Melanie/Paulette Van der Kloot

Contract approved.

Paul Ruseau: I am happy that we can feel confident that we have Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent for four more years. It is definitely going to be a brighter future.

Melanie: I second Paul Ruseau's sentiments. We are fortunate to have you.

Roll: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz Melanie, Mea, Paul Ruseau, Paulette, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn 7 affirmative/0 negative: contract approved

IX. Report of Superintendent

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments

Insert comments: breaking news of a shooting at a school in Knoxville, TN.

Breaking Now! Knoxville Police Department (KPD) in Tennessee said that multiple agencies are at the scene of a shooting at Austin-East Magnet High School. One person died, and the shooter is in custody.

Before I begin this evening, I would like to bring to your attention the following: last night an African American male, Daunte Wright, was killed by police in Minnesota yesterday, less than 10 miles from where Mr. George Floyd was killed. A curfew of 5 PM was put in place by the Mayor Elliot of Brooklyn Center, a suburb of Minneapolis. Additionally, I would like to read a statement from the Minnesota Twins: "Out of respect for the tragic events that occurred yesterday in Brooklyn Center, and following the additional details in this evolving situation, the Minnesota Twins have decided it is in the best interests of our fans, staff, players and community to not play today's game against the Red Sox." While we don't know what exactly happened an investigation is ongoing. We send prayers to Mr. Wright's family and all involved.

While discussing these events, I also must state how grateful I am that the Medford Human Rights Commission led another community conversation on the uncomfortable, yet extremely important, need for racial equity. I thank Mayor Lungo Koehn, Chief Jack Buckley and Maryann O'Connor of the Board of Health who realize the importance of addressing these issues of race in our community. Additionally, over 140 members of the community actively participated in last Wednesday night's discussion. Special thanks to Neil Osborne for organizing these ongoing community conversations as we work together to improve the quality of life for all in our community. I will end with a quote from Jackie Robinson that resonates with me: "I'm not concerned with you liking or disliking me. All I ask is that you respect me as a human being."

Today, we began our four days per week of in-person instruction for students in grades 6 - 12 at the Andrews, McGlynn, and Medford High School. Following April vacation, on Monday, April 26th, we will return to five-days per week of in-person instruction for grades 6 - 12 as we continue to increase normality in our schools.

I would like to thank Congresswoman Katherine Clark for choosing to visit the McGlynn School Complex last Thursday. She wanted to see the testing and the students in the classrooms. Both the Mayor and myself thanked her for the assistance of the federal Cares Act monies. The Congresswoman spoke to us about the importance of passing the American Rescue Plan, another Covid-19 relief package that could see Medford receive an additional \$5 million dollars. She explained that the funding is intended to help schools with HVAC improvements, technology and

PPE, as well as, helping students to make up for lost learning time potentially in the form of summer school or after-school programs. She was very impressed with the students covid testing themselves and loved interacting with our elementary students.

We appreciate the members of the community who participated in the roundtable discussions about the MPS Strategic Plan. Additionally, I would like to thank members of the cabinet and department heads who also actively participated in these important conversations. Please know that we will utilize the feedback as we continue to move forward on the district's plan.

This evening begins Ramadan for our Muslim families, friends and neighbors. Ramadan continues until May 12th and is considered the most sacred month for the whole Muslim Ummah- you ask for forgiveness. You exercise self-control. You try to experience the life of the have-not. Experiencing what the have-nots experience all the time. It teaches empathy, putting yourself in someone else's shoes (like a homeless person). It is my hope that during this holy season, happiness and joy will fill your homes. Ramadan Kareem (Middle East) or Ramadan Mubarak (Asian- Malaysia or Pakistan)- Enjoy the blessings...of this holy month.

Last week, Medford resident Lauren Stern, who works for iRobot, visited Mrs. Laskey's remote 4th Grade class at the McGlynn Elementary School, as part of a computer class lesson about Robotics and Algorithms. Lauren presented fun examples, particularly on ways Roomba reacts or performs an action. During the interactive presentation, students asked questions and engaged in dialogues about robots. Special thanks to Ms. Laskey and computer teacher Ms. Elias, who organized the presentation.

I want to extend our sincere thanks to following organizations who have graciously made donations of the following to the Medford Public Schools:

Rich Raymond and Sean Mangan of Armstrong Ambulance for donating Stop the Bleed kits for the LoConte Ice Skating Rink facility. We appreciate their consistent support in helping to keep our athletes healthy and safe.

Katie Marino of Skin Therapy in Station Landing, donated (7) Skin Therapy facial kits to a teacher in each of the Medford Public Schools. Additionally, Katie sent a special kit to Ms. Malloy, and took the time to stock many of the Micro Pantries with non-perishable items. Lastly, Skin Therapy raised \$275 which they donated to the Mustang Senior Class. Katie is mom to Derek, a student at Medford High School and to Marc and James, students at the Roberts Elementary School. .

Wegmans who donated over 200 bottles of hand sanitizer for our students.

Tufts University who donated office furniture for teachers and staff who needed an extra desk, file cabinet, storage closet, or bookcase.

All of these groups have been so kind to remember the Medford Public Schools staff and students and we appreciate their generosity.

A Few Important Dates!

This Thursday, April 15th from 3-4 PM, via Zoom the Middle School Lottery drawing will be held. Parents and guardians are invited to dial into the drawing. All results will be posted on the district website and blog and will be available to view within hours of the drawing. Letters confirming each student's middle school assignment will be sent to all grade 5 students by April 22, 2021. If

you have not received or misplaced your child's unique identification number, please reach out to Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli and she will be able to assist you. (bricciardelli@medford.k12.ma.us)

This Friday, April 16th, is the deadline to submit applications to participate in the Advisory Committee to Rename the Columbus Elementary School as well as suggestions for new names.

Next week is April Vacation, April 19th - 23rd - there will be no instruction during this time. For those who might be traveling, please note that Covid is not over and Nurse Toni Wray will be following my remarks with Covid safety travel and return to school instructions.

The last day of school for the 2020-2021 school year will be Friday, June 18th.

Lastly, I would like to take a moment to remember an important anniversary that is coming up this Thursday. Back in 2013, on Patriot's Day, April 15th, the sunny spring day brought with it the usual: the ride of Paul Revere, the Red Sox playing at Fenway Park and the running of the Marathon. But, the day quickly turned dark as the Marathon became the site of terrorist bombings. One of our own Medford Mustangs, Krystle Campbell, was lost on that horrible day. This Thursday, it is my hope that you will take a moment and remember those both lost and injured on "One Boston Day" with Reflection, Prayer & Unity.

Thank you and have a good evening!

2. COVID-19 Public Health Update & MPS COVID-19 Testing Summary and Update - Nurse Supervisor Toni Wray, Ms. MaryAnn O'Connor - Board of Health & Mr. David Murphy

City data: avg. 25.9 per 100,000 cases/ 1.38 positivity rate/MPS: 2800 tests - 4 positive cases

Increasing cases of positive pediatric cases. More MA residents vaccinated each week including teaching staff. April 19, open to all residents age 16 and older. Number of positive cases among positive population is increasing. UK strain is dominant in MA. Spreads more quickly and easily. Thought to be responsible for increase in positive cases in children. Obey protocols. Follow travel advisory: all visitors entering MA advised to quarantine for ten days upon entry into state. Fully vaccinated residents (two weeks past second dose) do not have to quarantine. Following state guidance will keep us safe and in school.

Paul Ruseau: When students travel over vacation, and are part of in person category, when they return on the 26th, who will their teachers be?

Toni: If you enter the state on Saturday, you can get a test on Sunday and hopefully get results on Monday, and come in on Tuesday.

Dave Murphy: If a student is prohibited from being in school, there is not a remote option for them. They need to stay home until they get a negative test result. There is not a simulcast option.

Paul Ruseau: Since this is the week before vacation, will be blasting what the expectations are? The state has changed it many times. I am worried about people who in good faith go away and don't realize what the steps are? I don't want to have to close down a school because of it. Everybody needs to know that if they go away, they need to have a test.

Dave Murphy: We will communicate that. The restrictions that have been imposed - with every school holiday or vacation, this is a constant refrain. We need to affirm it but no one should be

taken by surprise. We will be testing that first monday.

Melanie: We need to know what the preferred method of communication is and we should broadcast accordingly. What is the data with in person and remote students? How many of each?

Dave Murphy: We do have that data? We have one off situations of families seeking transfers. 60 to 65% district wide in person.

3. Report on Middle School Math Curriculum: Math Director, Faiza Khan

Paulette Van der Kloot: Letter from public Michelle Ciccolo.

Faiza Khan: I received a copy of the letter and most are addressed in the report.

Dear Members of the School Committee,

I have some questions for Ms. Khan about the report on the math curriculum and would appreciate if this letter was read then.

1. Have the programs that the elementary schools can possibly pilot been narrowed yet or is that part of what the committee is going to decide? What are the programs that are still in consideration?

2. What is the plan for the current middle schoolers for the 21-22 school year? Will the 7th or 8th graders have an accelerated class? Or, are we planning on definitely choosing one of the high school acceleration options?

3. If the advanced pathway is chosen that begins in 9th grade (figure 4):

A. How are the enhanced classes different from the regular classes? How much from pre-Calculus needs to be pushed into these enhanced classes for students to be ready for Calculus? Could these topics be covered in the regular classes for all students?

B. What are the pathways for late-bloomers in math to get into the advanced pathway and for students who decide to switch out?

C. Could there be another option where all students take Algebra, Geometry, Algebra II and then senior year, when students have a better idea of what they want to do after graduation, they split into an "enhanced" Calculus or take one of the other math options?

4. This is very focused on the advanced students, but what are we doing to close the achievement gap, especially from the events of the last year? How can we close the gap without relying heavily on summer school, excessive after school tutoring, excessive homework, or keeping students

back?

Thank you,

Michelle Ciccolo

28 Douglas Rd

Faiza's presentation:

[Report Link here:](#)

[Presentation Link here:](#)

This is focused on advanced students, but how can we close the gap?

Faiza Khan: very important question. This will shape our teaching and learning next year. We know that there was loss due to remote learning. I prefer that we don't rely on summer school, excessive homework, after school or keeping kids back. We will explore what the best options are: suggested that we don't spend too much time reviewing at beginning of year. Better to address the needs as they arise within new instruction. We are working on ways not to compromise mental health of students but give them the instruction they need.

Any questions ?:

Paul Ruseau: Thank you Faiza. When the RPE sub met a few weeks ago, there was a brief conversation about who is in honors/ap/others? The concept of tracking is not a force for equity for sure. Is the accelerated math course tracking with a different name?

Faiza Khan: One thing we must admit is that it definitely serves a certain population. IT is important to have proper structures in place so that we place the right students in the course. We also have in the past honored parents' wishes to put students in the accelerated pathway. It is not for everyone. I cannot say that all students would be able to do it. I believe it can play with students' confidence with this placement. We will continue to advise and suggest using the data points we have. We do want to honor their wishes. If we give the students due time, they will get to Calculus. A year and a half of standards in one year is not an easy feat. We will be careful. I need to look at all data points for this coming year and parents need to be very sure of what students want.

Paul Ruseau: I just want to make sure there is an active communication going on about which students are being chosen for this coursework. Concerned about bias in choice of students.

Faiza Khan; Biggest concern is that we reflect upon our biases and look at the structures in place. I am hoping that this committee that this will be the overarching umbrella. We would like it to be as equitable as possible. We have been having these conversations. It is a work in progress. I am well aware of this. The first step is the committee members review what is in the back of our mind and whether we are serving all of our students well. The reflective practitioner piece is very important.

Paulette Van der Kloot : another letter from parent, Juliet Gainsborough.

Dear Members of the School Committee and Mayor Lungo-Koehn,

I am watching the school committee meeting on the public access station. I am watching the math presentation. The question that has not been answered is what about this year's seventh grade students who were not given the option to accelerate. I thought they would be given the option in eighth grade. But, based on this presentation it does not sound as though any option is being offered that will address them. I would appreciate it if someone would ask a question about this.

Sincerely,

Juliet Gainsborough, Parent of a 7th Grader (Andrews) and a 10th Grader (MHS)

115 Allston St.

Faiza Khan: The 7th graders that were not given the opportunity last year will be given that option this year. The letters will be going home to 6th and 7th graders. Placement tests are just one factor to be considered.

4. Before and after school programming- Suzanne Galusi and Megan Fiddler-Carey

Paulette Van der Kloot: The following letter was submitted to School Committee:

Dear School Committee Members,

I, Theresa Fernald, from 13 Whittier Rd. Medford, am submitting this request and question on behalf of almost 40 families who have joined together in support of the expansion and further development of accessible, equitable and inclusive after school care in Medford, MA.

We request that I be granted 5 minutes instead of 3 during the after school topic

(agenda 9.4) and that the below questions be read aloud during the meeting prior to our 5 mins for this agenda item.

Medford Parents For Better After and Before School Care:

We have built a network of approximately 40 families who are ready, willing and eager to be part of identifying and executing solutions related to the after school crisis in Medford, MA.

To build off the MPS / School Committee “Mission Roundtables” held April 4 & 5, we know the current mission statement is changing (and we support this change). However, we would like to ask the following as it relates to the mission calling for MPS to be a “partnership of school, family and community.”

What is the best way for parents to get involved in brainstorming and execution of solutions for our city’s afterschool crisis?

Beyond attending a school committee meeting, how do we start a conversation towards solving the after school crisis that builds towards a true partnership between parents, school and city leadership, in addition to the larger community?

To clarify - we are not here to ask you to open spots for only our families, we are asking you to allow us to help find a larger solution that supports families in our whole city.

*As discussed during the meeting last week, related to the mission statement “...to ensure that **all** students are afforded a safe and healthy learning environment.”, our goal is that no student is excluded from that “all”.*

If you’d like to know more about our group on your own (not requesting it be shared at the meeting), you can find that here:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1y0ouWqiepYVZ0TWcECVvqQosO3V4BDYqgfa37glZaDw/edit?usp=sharing>

Thank you,

Parents Working for a Better MPS Committee

- *Andre Quina & Emily Perrotta*
- *Christina Roberts*
- *Dallas Scott & Haskell Kent*
- *Danielle Blackwell*
- *Deirdre Hosler*
- *Emily Jameson & Dennis Anderson*
- *Nicole Dillon*
- *Theresa Fernald*
- *Vanessa Farzner*

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: thanks to all who worked on this presentation. The sentiments and

questions offered at the roundtable were helpful. MPS is looking at the AS/BS programming closely.

[Link to slide deck here](#)

Paul Ruseau: thanks for sending this ahead of time. What is missing is the failure to meet this need. Charter school tuition is \$8.7 million dollars because parents choose there for guaranteed after school. Once kid number one goes to the charter school, they don't enter future kids into the lottery because of lack of after school care in MPS. Amount of money we lose to this, dwarfs the amount of money we lose to the entire program. Hard to talk about because the money is not part of our budget. Problem is so much bigger. I don't see this in the presentation. I am 100% opposed to privatization in any sort. Just like wait lists don't go with public education, neither does privatization. Affordability is not defined and it is important to acknowledge that affordability is talking about people who are resource constrained. We have to nail down what we mean by affordability. There is a huge value to having your child stay in the same location. Staff turnover is a major issue and I was happy to see an increase in the wages.

Paulette Van der Kloot: thanks to all who worked on this (Megan Fidler-Carey, Dave Murphy, and Suzanne Galusi): Increased wages will help to hire for the program. Always been a difficult place to hire for due to the short schedule at an off time of day. I have heard wonderful feedback. If I am looking at this, we are adding 60 spaces but we have 144 on the waitlist. That is still 84 families disenfranchised. I understand your being realistic in projections and concerns with staffing and space. How are we going to accommodate the other families who are not being accommodated through this. Parents have mentioned wanting to be cooperative players.

Dave Murphy: It is not uncommon to have a waitlist at this point. The likelihood is that some on the waitlist end up with a seat. That being said, disenfranchised families, it is meant to note that this is not a core service of the district. The district has decided to offer the program and it does pose a conflict to offer a service that they cannot provide to every family. We want to provide as much service as we can but we need to be honest about what we can provide. There is a distinction there. This is a self sustaining program and this group of employees cannot be compared to any other group of employees.

Jenny Graham: If we move forward with the hopes to expand and you find that you have more applicants then you have room for, can you expand beyond the 60 seats?

David Murphy : We will come to ask about tuition increases but we will not come to ask for additional seats. There are considerations: space, safety and security, health services,

administrative costs, reasons not to expand overnight. We would need to look at options that are not on the table. 4th and 5th graders could be transferred to a different location - that would change demand (separated siblings). We could be wrong about ability to hire additional staff.

Jenny Graham : This committee has been told that space is not the issue that limits capacity. If you need something from this committee, we will take action on this as fast as we can. There are families on the waitlist. There are families who don't even know the process. We are not solving the problem of after school care for elementary schools.

Dave Murphy: It is a much bigger issue. As we solve one problem, new ones are created.

Jenny Graham: I would like to make a motion to accept the wage increases and rate increases for the after school program. Seconded by Paul Ruseau.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would like to hear from some parents before voting on the motion.

Teresa Fernald, Whittier Rd: We appreciate the report but the report does not provide relief for the families who are disenfranchised. This is a fundamental issue for our community. As Paul mentioned, families have to leave public school out of sheer need. I registered my oldest child for Kindergarten. We received an email adding him to the waitlist. We understand that very few k families get spots each year. If you don't get it K year, there is little chance you will get off the waitlist. We were told we were at the bottom. We have a brainstorming group. We gathered information and we are a network of 40 families interested in staying informed and active in the brainstorming. We appreciated being part of the strategic planning group. Our goal is that every body that needs a spot will get one. We strive for a reality where 0 will have to leave. We have to address this in an equitable way. Equitable does not mean equal when it comes to affordability. We want to partner. This may require a set of solutions and want to be part of executing these solutions to make this a community solution set.

Vanessa Farzner, Barbara Lane: Thank you for the presentation. Things I want to bring up again: this is not about us getting a spot. This is about equity. I am disappointed to hear that a sliding scale is complicated. The waitlist is higher at the Brooks school. It is not affordable at the other schools. We are not meeting the needs of all families across Medford. A sliding scale fee is essential. I have not heard of other locations being used. Buses to the high school or other locations? What you have proposed for wage increases won't meet minimum wage in January 2023. Two more points, why a four day option? Three day/two day/five day options make more sense. More transparency going forward. I have been on the waitlist for over a year. Thank you for looking at options.

Andre Quina, Johnson Ave. in Medford. Lot of our points are similar. ONE thing I will add, I see it differently. We have a child going into first grade because we sent him to private school this year. Grace works only has a couple of spots. Our only option is to hire an individual caregiver \$10,400

Melanie McLaughlin: I would like to second the motion on the wage increase but would like to continue the conversation as to the sliding scale and also would like to know what the training will be for staff working with students with disabilities.

Roll: Yes 7/0 motion passes

Melanie McLaughlin : Motion to have a meeting with the parents of this group in the next 6 weeks.

Paulette Van der Kloot; question on this - we have a very tight schedule right now with budget sessions. Can we ask Megan to spearhead this meeting. We had 22 meetings last month. I want to be responsive. It doesn't seem like the most effective way.

Dave Murphy: I echo Paulette Van der Kloot's concerns. I don't think directing a staff member to hold this meeting will have any particular consequences. There is a lot of research that needs to be done.

Melanie McLaughlin: I don't need a school committee meeting. I want to make sure that the working group recommendations are shared with the administration. I am looking for engagement for this family group. I am happy to be involved in it and I would like it to happen before the end of May.

Jenny Graham : I don't think it is reasonable to happen before the end of may. There is a lot of rebuilding that needs to happen. It is also budget season. I would like to make sure that the Admin will make good on the policy decisions we just approved. We need to know sooner than later if that is going to work. We don't want to head into september without answers to this question. We need to give the administration space to act. Ms. FC is capable of doing that. It is not imperative that the superintendent be included in every single meeting.

David Murphy : there are a lot of stakeholders who have a lot at stake. I appreciate the more plausible timeline. Ultimately the School Committee has to decide what is best for the community on this.

Jenny Graham; Before we wrap in the month of June, can we get an update on this situation.

Paulette Van der Kloot; I was going to suggest the same thing. We need to give space to do the

budget. This needs to be in the mix. We all want the same thing.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would like to have some idea as to how we will gather feedback from the families regarding the before and after school programs. We have had roundtables and we need to have a discussion not at 10:30 at night.

Paulette Van der Kloot; I fully agree with hearing from parents but I don't know that we need a formalized process. We have a very active engaged group of parents who have made their voices heard. I trust our staff.

Melanie McLaughlin: it is a matter of structure. Families tonight why they were not incorporated into the presentation tonight. Families need to know that more families can come and share their concerns.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: we could put a motion on the floor that we will continue this conversation internally and externally and will increase as many spots as we can responsibly add.

Dave Murphy: We are engaged with families on an hourly basis. We engage with families all day every day to make sure that the priorities of students are met. We will continue that engagement.

Melanie McLaughlin: We hear from some families that they are not included. I have asked to put this forward that we have a listening session about the Before School/After School program.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Motion on the floor. No second.

Jenny Graham: through the chair to Melanie McLaughlin; this was the primary topic of conversation at the two listening sessions. I do want to make sure you know that this was happening in our subgroup to a great extent. We have done some of that work already. I would encourage the administration to reach out to some of these parents further. They may have perspective in other ways. Logistics of a big meeting might not be good right now.

Melanie McLaughlin: Thank you to member Graham. I would like to have the documentation.

Paulette Van der Kloot: It was in the minutes.

X. Old Business

1. Good of the Order- *Offered by Melanie Mclaughlin*

Tabled until next meeting. Roll call; 7/0

XI. Communications

XII. New Business

1. Resolution in Support of Expedited COVID-19 Vaccinations for Students

Whereas as of April 12, 2021, the Coronavirus (COVID-19) pandemic has infected over 30.4 million individuals in the United States and has resulted in more than 551,638 deaths across the country and 17,185 in Massachusetts;

Whereas our strong public education system, which is essential to the individual and community well-being of our society, is facing unprecedented challenges due to the Coronavirus pandemic and lack of clear national, state, and local direction or resources. These challenges include, but are not limited to, the academic and social-emotional toll on students, as well as the need to rapidly pivot to distance learning; clean and equip school facilities to adapt to new health protocols and social distancing; assess and address the risks to teachers, staff, and students;

Whereas vaccines are proven to be the most effective strategy to reduce and eliminate the spread of infectious diseases and are an important and necessary tool for eradicating disease and vaccines are anticipated to be approved for use for some school aged children in the coming weeks;

Whereas the current Commonwealth vaccine distribution system created access issues for eligible residents that could create greater access disparities among school aged children; and

Whereas Medford Public Schools is committed to the health and safety of its students and staff; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. calls on the State Legislature, the Governor, the Massachusetts Department of Public Health, create a vaccine rollout plan for school aged children that puts the distribution in the hands of local officials and eliminates accessibility barriers to students and their families;
2. calls on the Massachusetts Association of School Committees (MASC) to publicly advocate for local control of vaccine distribution for school aged children; and
3. directs the district the Superintendent to transmit official copies of this resolution to the following: the Commissioner of the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education, the Governor of Massachusetts, Senator Elizabeth Warren, Senator Edward Markey, Congresswoman Katherine Clark, State Senator Patricia Jehlen, State Representative Paul Donato, State Representative Sean Garballey, State Representative Christine Barber, and the Massachusetts Association of School Committees (MASC).

- Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau
Motion to approve: Jenny Graham/Paul Ruseau
Roll: 7/0 approved

2. Whereas the current School Committee Policy GCA - PROFESSIONAL STAFF POSITIONS states:

All professional staff positions in the school system will be created initially by the School Committee. It is the Committee's intent to activate a sufficient number of positions to accomplish the school system's goals and objectives and to provide for the equitable staffing of each school building. Although such positions may remain temporarily unfilled, only the Committee may abolish a position it has created.

Each time a new position is established by the Committee, the Superintendent will present for the Committee's approval a job description for the position, which specifies the jobholder's qualifications and the job's performance responsibilities. The Superintendent will maintain a comprehensive set of job descriptions for all positions.

NOTE: Job descriptions for professional staff positions are available for review in the office of the Superintendent.

Be it resolved that the School Committee amends policy GCA - Professional Staff Positions to ensure transparency, relevancy, and accountability across all professional staff job functions.

All professional staff positions in the school system will be created initially by the School Committee. It is the Committee's intent to activate a sufficient number of positions to accomplish the school system's goals and objectives and to provide for the equitable staffing of each school building. Professional Staff is defined as department heads, central office staff, nursing,

The Superintendent will maintain a comprehensive list of positions and set of job descriptions for all positions. All job descriptions will be reviewed every three years and presented to the School Committee for approval. Job descriptions will contain a last reviewed date. The Superintendent will establish a review cycle for all position descriptions within 60 days of the adoption of this policy. The initial review cycle will last for no longer than three years and conclude by September 1, 2024.

Effective September 1, 2021, the comprehensive list and current job descriptions for professional staff positions are available for review by the public on the MPS website.

Each time a new position is established by the Committee, the Superintendent will present for the Committee's approval a job description for the position, which specifies the jobholder's qualifications and the job's performance responsibilities.

Although such positions may remain temporarily unfilled, only the Committee may abolish a position it has created.

All positions unfilled for the entire prior school year will be reported to the Committee annually no later than June 1st, with an explanation for the vacancy.

All positions that remain unfilled for more than two consecutive school years will be presented to the Committee to be abolished no later than June 1st. In the event the Superintendent wishes to maintain any positions that have been unfilled for more than two consecutive school years the Superintendent must explain the rationale and plan to fill the position and get approval from the Committee to continue the unfilled position for an additional year.

- *Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau*

Motion to table to next agenda: Jenny Graham/Paulette Van der Kloot

Roll: 7/0

Motion tabled until April 26, 2021

3. School Committee Resolution: Condolences:

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Mr. James F. "Jim" McKinnon, a former English teacher, head football coach and sub-master at Medford High School.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Mr. Alan K. McDougall, former Mustang Football Captain of 1985 Greater Boston League Champions, and former Freshman football coach at Medford High School.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Mr. Leon Appiani, the son of the late Mr. Leo Appiani, former math teacher and varsity boys basketball coach at Medford High School.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Mr. Alphonso J. Citrano, great uncle of Mrs. Gina Citrano of the Medford Public Schools Business Office.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Mrs. Amit-un-Nisa Begum, mother-in-law of Math Director Mrs. Faiza Khan.

Motion to adjourn Melanie McLaughlin/Jenny Graham

Roll: 7/0

Meeting adjourned at 10:42pm.